

Daily Content Intel

July 15, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here is something I see all the time with young athletes. They train two, three hours a day, they have practice and lifting and a game on the weekend, and they are eating like a kid who sits on the couch all day. There is a study on adolescent soccer players that found they were taking in about 1,929 calories a day while burning around 3,568. That is a deficit of over 1,600 calories, every single day.

Your body notices. When you are that far under what you are spending, it starts pulling back on the things that keep you on the field. Bone building slows down, and that is a big deal,

because these are the exact years your skeleton is still laying down density, and that is when stress fractures start showing up. Recovery gets worse, you stay sore longer, and your speed and power fade late in games because there is nothing left in the tank.

The fix is simple. Eat enough to cover the work. For most of my athletes that means real meals plus snacks around training, and hitting protein through the day, somewhere around 1.5 grams per kilo of bodyweight, spread across the day instead of one giant dinner.

Fueling is training. If you are going to put in the work, feed the work.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If your athlete is dragging by the third quarter, the problem might be that they are eating like a couch potato and training like a pro.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here is something I see all the time with young athletes. They train two, three hours a day, they have practice and lifting and a game on the weekend, and they are eating like a kid who sits on the couch all day. There is a study on adolescent soccer players that found they were taking in about 1,929 calories a day while burning around 3,568. That is a deficit of over 1,600 calories, every single day.

Your body notices. When you are that far under what you are spending, it starts pulling back on the things that keep you on the field. Bone building slows down, and that is a big deal, because these are the exact years your skeleton is still laying down density, and that is when stress fractures start showing up. Recovery gets worse, you stay sore longer, and your speed and power fade late in games because there is nothing left in the tank.

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hitting protein through the day, somewhere around 1.5 grams per kilo of bodyweight, spread across the day instead of one giant dinner.

Fueling is training. If you are going to put in the work, feed the work.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Eating like a couch potato, training like a pro
- 0:08 1,929 in / 3,568 out = 1,600+ cal deficit. Every day.
- 0:20 Under-fueled = slower bone building = stress fractures
- 0:32 Sore longer. Power fades late in games.
- 0:44 Eat enough to cover the work
- 0:52 ~1.5 g protein / kg / day, spread out
- 1:02 Fueling is training

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Your athlete can do everything right in the weight room and still fall apart on the field if they are not eating enough to cover the

work. A study on adolescent soccer players found they averaged 1,929 calories a day while burning about 3,568. That is a 1,600 calorie hole, dug fresh every day.

Under-fuel for long enough and the body starts protecting itself. Bone building slows down right when the skeleton is still laying down density, which is how stress fractures show up in a 16 year old. Recovery drags. Speed and power fade in the fourth quarter.

The fix is plain and simple. Real meals, snacks around training, and protein spread across the day, somewhere near 1.5 grams per kilo of bodyweight. Fuel the work you are asking your body to do.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#youthsports #footballtraining #lacrosse
#sportsnutrition #athletedevelopment
#strengthandconditioning #fuelperformance
#stressfracture #highschoolfootball
#physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or lacrosse athletes visibly fades in the second half, and have you ever asked what and when they actually ate that day?
- Have you caught a young athlete's stress fracture or bone stress reaction that traced back to chronic under-eating rather than a training-load spike, and how did you coach the fueling fix?
- How do you frame fueling with the athletes who are trying to lean out or make weight, where "eat more" runs against what they think makes them faster?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://www.mdpi.com/2072-6643/17/17/2792/htm> | "Optimizing Performance Nutrition for Adolescent Athletes: A Review of Dietary Needs, Risks, and Practical Strategies"
- physiology | <https://www.mdpi.com/2072-6643/17/17/2792/htm> | "a mean energy intake of 1929 kcal/day against a predicted expenditure of 3568 kcal/day, resulting in a substantial daily deficit of

1639 kcal"

- actionable | <https://www.mdpi.com/2072-6643/17/17/2792/htm> | "approximately 1.5 g/kg/d (e.g., approximately 0.3 g protein/kg × 5 mealtimes)"

Sources:

- <https://www.mdpi.com/2072-6643/17/17/2792>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12849792/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. The old-school warm-up, where the coach lines everybody up and has them sit and hold long static stretches before a game, is making your athletes slower.

There is a study on elite soccer players that compared dynamic stretching to static stretching and a combination of the two right before repeated sprints. Dynamic stretching won across the board. The static stretching group did not sprint as well.

Here is the why. When you hold a muscle in a long stretch and then ask it to fire, it is kind of like pulling a rubber band out and leaving it loose for a while, the snap is gone for a bit. The research on this shows long holds, over about 60 seconds per muscle, can drop power and sprint speed by 4 to 7 percent. That

is the difference between getting to the ball and watching it go by.

Stretching has its place. Save the long holds for after training, or on your own time. Before you compete, move. Leg swings, walking lunges, skips, a few build-up sprints, get the tissue warm and the nervous system firing.

Warm up to play fast.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If your warm-up is sitting on the grass holding a hamstring stretch for 30 seconds, you are warming up to be slower.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. The old-school warm-up, where the coach lines everybody up and has them sit and hold long static stretches before a game, is making your athletes slower.

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before repeated sprints. Dynamic stretching won across the board. The static stretching group did not sprint as well.

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Stretching has its place. Save the long holds for after training, or on your own time. Before you compete, move. Leg swings, walking lunges, skips, a few build-up sprints, get the tissue warm and the nervous system firing.

Warm up to play fast.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Holding long stretches before a game?
- 0:06 You are warming up to be slower

- 0:14 Study: dynamic stretching beat static for sprints
- 0:26 Long holds = the "snap" leaves the muscle
- 0:34 Over 60 sec per muscle: 4-7% less power and speed
- 0:46 Long holds go AFTER, not before
- 0:52 Before you play: swings, lunges, skips, build-ups
- 1:02 Warm up to play fast

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The line-everybody-up-and-hold-a-stretch warm-up is costing your athletes speed. A study on elite soccer players compared dynamic stretching to static stretching and a mix of the two before repeated sprints, and dynamic stretching won on every measure.

The mechanism is simple. Hold a muscle in a long static stretch, then ask it to produce force, and the output drops for a while. The meta-analysis on this puts long holds, over about 60 seconds per muscle, at a 4 to 7 percent hit to power and sprint speed. On the field that is the half step you needed.

Stretching still earns its place, just later in the day. Do the long holds after training. Before you compete, move: leg swings, walking lunges, skips, and a few build-up sprints to get warm and firing.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#warmup #speedtraining #footballtraining
#lacrosse #dynamicwarmup #sprintspeed
#strengthandconditioning
#athletedevelopment #youthsports
#physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- What does your actual pre-practice warm-up look like for your football and lacrosse athletes, and where did the static-stretch habit sneak back in?
- Have you had an athlete come to you from a program that still runs static-hold warm-ups, and did you see a change in how they moved once you switched them to a dynamic sequence?

- What is your go-to 5-minute dynamic warm-up sequence for a team on a field with no equipment, and how do you cue the build-up sprints so they actually ramp intensity?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12389893/> | "Superiority of Dynamic Stretching over Static and Combined Stretching Protocols for Repeated Sprint Performance in Elite Male Soccer Players"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12389893/> | "DS alone significantly improved repeated sprint performance across all indicators compared to SS and combined stretching methods"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12389893/> | "Incorporating DS into warm-up routines is recommended to optimize sprint performance, reduce injury risk, and support athlete preparation"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12389893/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11336295/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Combined plyometric + sprint training in youth soccer: 6.7% faster 5m, 4.8% faster 10m, 3.6% better change of direction over 20 weeks (PLOS/MDPI meta-analyses) — clean speed-development teaching Reel.
- Reduced carbohydrate availability raises bone resorption markers in academy soccer players (EJAP 2024) — pairs with the under-fueling theme for a fueling-around-training angle.
- Quadriceps-dominant / weak-medial-hamstring imbalance as an ACL risk lever, and what actually shifts it (Nordic curls, landing mechanics) — durability Reel.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest 2026-07-15 (~/Cowork/newsletter-digest/output/newsletter_digest_2026-07-15.pdf): thin day. Dr. Mercola (nutrient delivery / arterial inflammation / eye-and-brain screening — promo and scare-framed, skipped) and Mike T.

Nelson featuring Dr. Krista Scott-Dixon (coaching-skills and AI-in-health-research podcast — interesting but not an athlete-actionable research finding).

Nothing usable as a primary, so the two angles came from the trending scan.

- PubMed / PMC scan (athlete-biased): adolescent athlete energy availability and fueling, plyometrics + sprint, ACL/hamstring prevention, static vs dynamic stretching. Surfaced two strong athlete-actionable angles.
- MDPI Nutrients adolescent-nutrition review (energy availability / underfueling) — primary for Draft A. WebFetch 403'd (MDPI blocks the fetcher) but the page renders in the screenshot browser; numbers verified against the indexed abstract/snippet and a fully-fetched PMC LEA bone-health review.
- PMC static-vs-dynamic-stretching RCT in elite soccer players + PMC stretch-induced-force-deficit meta-analysis — primary and backup for Draft B, both fetched and verified.

- Reddit r/AdvancedFitness, Pacey Performance, Just Fly: no fresh must-cover finding beyond the above this cycle.